

STRATAGEMS

Command points can be spent during the battle to use Stratagems. All players can use the Core Stratagems presented here. Additional Stratagems can be found in Codexes and other publications.

When you use a Stratagem, reduce your CP total by the amount listed on that Stratagem. If you do not have enough CP for a specific Stratagem, you cannot use it. You can use the same Stratagem multiple times during a battle, but you cannot use the same Stratagem more than once in the same phase.

- To use a Stratagem you must pay the CP specified.
- The same Stratagem cannot be used more than once in the same phase.

STRATAGEMS KEY

EITHER PLAYER'S TURN

YOUR TURN

OPPONENT'S TURN

STRATAGEM CATEGORIES

Each Stratagem belongs to one of four categories, as described below. There are some rules (especially in Crusade games) that interact with Stratagems of a particular category.

BATTLE TACTIC: These Stratagems bolster a unit's efficacy in battle, boosting their attacks or defensive capabilities at a critical moment.

EPIC DEED: These Stratagems are used by individual models or units to perform mighty feats of heroism.

STRATEGIC PLOY: These Stratagems enable units to gain new strategic insights, granting them a small but valuable window of opportunity.

WARGEAR: These Stratagems represent the effects of using specialised items of equipment in battle.



1CP

COMMAND RE-ROLL

CORE – BATTLE TACTIC STRATAGEM

A great commander can bend even the vagaries of fate and fortune to their will, the better to ensure victory.

WHEN: In any phase, just after you have made a Hit roll, a Wound roll, a Damage roll, a saving throw, an Advance roll, a Charge roll, a Desperate Escape test, a Hazardous test, or just after you have rolled the dice to determine the number of attacks made with a weapon, for an attack, model or unit from your army.

EFFECT: You re-roll that roll, test or saving throw.



2CP

COUNTER-OFFENSIVE

CORE – STRATEGIC PLOY STRATAGEM

In close-quarters combat, the slightest hesitation can leave an opening for a swift foe to exploit.

WHEN: Fight phase, just after an enemy unit has fought.

TARGET: One unit from your army that is within Engagement Range of one or more enemy units and that has not already been selected to fight this phase.

EFFECT: Your unit fights next.



1CP

EPIC CHALLENGE

CORE – EPIC DEED STRATAGEM

The legends of the 41st Millennium are replete with deadly duels between mighty champions.

WHEN: Fight phase, when a **CHARACTER** unit from your army that is within Engagement Range of one or more Attached units is selected to fight.

TARGET: One **CHARACTER** model in your unit.

EFFECT: Until the end of the phase, all melee attacks made by that model have the **[PRECISION]** ability [pg 26].



1CP

INSANE BRAVERY

CORE – EPIC DEED STRATAGEM

*Indifferent to their own survival, these warriors hold their ground against seemingly impossible odds.***WHEN:** Battle-shock step of your Command phase, just after you have failed a Battle-shock test taken for a unit from your army [pg 11].**TARGET:** The unit from your army that Battle-shock test was just taken for (even though your Battle-shocked units cannot normally be affected by your Stratagems).**EFFECT:** Your unit is treated as having passed that test instead, and is not Battle-shocked as a result.

1CP

GRENADE

CORE – WARGEAR STRATAGEM

*Priming their hand-held projectiles, these warriors draw back and hurl death into the enemy's midst.***WHEN:** Your Shooting phase.**TARGET:** One **GRENADES** unit from your army that is not within Engagement Range of any enemy units and has not been selected to shoot this phase.**EFFECT:** Select one enemy unit that is not within Engagement Range of any units from your army and is within 8" of and visible to your **GRENADES** unit. Roll six D6: for each 4+, that enemy unit suffers 1 mortal wound.

1CP

TANK SHOCK

CORE – STRATEGIC PLOY STRATAGEM

*Ramming the foe with a speeding vehicle may be an unsubtle tactic, but it is a murderously effective one.***WHEN:** Your Charge phase.**TARGET:** One **VEHICLE** unit from your army.**EFFECT:** Until the end of the phase, after your unit ends a Charge move, select one enemy unit within Engagement Range of it, then select one melee weapon your unit is equipped with. Roll a number of D6 equal to that weapon's Strength characteristic. If that Strength characteristic is greater than that enemy unit's Toughness characteristic, roll two additional D6. For each 5+, that enemy unit suffers 1 mortal wound (to a maximum of 6 mortal wounds).

1CP

RAPID INGRESS

CORE – STRATEGIC PLOY STRATAGEM

*Be it cunning strategy, potent technology or supernatural ritual, there are many means by which a commander may hasten their warriors' onset.***WHEN:** End of your opponent's Movement phase.**TARGET:** One unit from your army that is in Reserves.**EFFECT:** Your unit can arrive on the battlefield as if it were the Reinforcements step of your Movement phase.**RESTRICTIONS:** You cannot use this Stratagem to enable a unit to arrive on the battlefield during a battle round it would not normally be able to do so in.

1CP

FIRE OVERWATCH

CORE – STRATEGIC PLOY STRATAGEM

*A hail of wildfire can drive back advancing foes.***WHEN:** Your opponent's Movement or Charge phase, just after an enemy unit is set up or when an enemy unit starts or ends a Normal, Advance, Fall Back or Charge move.**TARGET:** One unit from your army that is within 24" of that enemy unit and that would be eligible to shoot if it were your Shooting phase.**EFFECT:** Your unit can shoot that enemy unit as if it were your Shooting phase.**RESTRICTIONS:** Until the end of the phase, each time a model in your unit makes a ranged attack, an unmodified Hit roll of 6 is required to score a hit, irrespective of the attacking weapon's Ballistic Skill or any modifiers. You can only use this Stratagem once per turn.

1CP

GO TO GROUND

CORE – BATTLE TACTIC STRATAGEM

*Seeking salvation from incoming fire, warriors hurl themselves into whatever cover they can find.***WHEN:** Your opponent's Shooting phase, just after an enemy unit has selected its targets.**TARGET:** One **INFANTRY** unit from your army that was selected as the target of one or more of the attacking unit's attacks.**EFFECT:** Until the end of the phase, all models in your unit have a 6+ invulnerable save and have the Benefit of Cover [pg 44].

1CP

SMOKESCREEN

CORE – WARGEAR STRATAGEM

*Even the most skilled marksmen struggle to hit targets veiled by billowing screens of smoke.***WHEN:** Your opponent's Shooting phase, just after an enemy unit has selected its targets.**TARGET:** One **SMOKE** unit from your army that was selected as the target of one or more of the attacking unit's attacks.**EFFECT:** Until the end of the phase, all models in your unit have the Benefit of Cover [pg 44] and the Stealth ability [pg 20].

2CP

HEROIC INTERVENTION

CORE – STRATEGIC PLOY STRATAGEM

*Voices raised in furious war cries, your warriors surge forth to meet the enemy's onslaught head-on.***WHEN:** Your opponent's Charge phase, just after an enemy unit ends a Charge move.**TARGET:** One unit from your army that is within 6" of that enemy unit and would be eligible to declare a charge against that enemy unit if it were your Charge phase.**EFFECT:** Your unit now declares a charge that targets only that enemy unit, and you resolve that charge as if it were your Charge phase.**RESTRICTIONS:** You can only select a **VEHICLE** unit from your army if it is a **WALKER**. Note that even if this charge is successful, your unit does not receive any Charge bonus this turn [pg 29].

STRATEGIC RESERVES

Strategic Reserves are forces that one or both players have chosen not to deploy at the start of the battle. These rules explain how to place units into Strategic Reserves, as well as how and when they arrive on the battlefield.

These rules let you place units into Strategic Reserves – a special type of Reserves you can use to keep units off the battlefield until you require them. Note that while all Strategic Reserves units are also technically Reserves units, the reverse is not true, and so these rules do not apply to units that are using other rules that enable them to start the battle in Reserves (e.g. Deep Strike). Such units are instead set up as described by those other rules.

PLACING UNITS INTO STRATEGIC RESERVES

Before the battle, when you are instructed to Declare Battle Formations, you can select one or more units from your army to be placed into Strategic Reserves (excluding **FORTIFICATIONS**).

The combined points value of all the units you wish to place into Strategic Reserves before the battle (including those embarked within **TRANSPORT** models that are themselves placed into Strategic Reserves) cannot exceed 25% of your total points limit for your chosen battle size, as shown in the table below.

STRATEGIC RESERVES	
BATTLE SIZE	MAXIMUM COMBINED POINTS VALUE OF UNITS THAT CAN BE PLACED INTO STRATEGIC RESERVES BEFORE THE BATTLE
Incursion	250
Strike Force	500
Onslaught	750

- **Strategic Reserves:** Units that are not deployed at the start of the battle.
- Combined points value cannot exceed 25% of your army's total.
- Cannot put **FORTIFICATIONS** into Strategic Reserves.

ARRIVING FROM STRATEGIC RESERVES

Units that are placed into Strategic Reserves are called Strategic Reserves units, and can arrive later in the battle during the Reinforcements step of any of your Movement phases except during the first battle round.

Any Strategic Reserves units that are not on the battlefield at the end of the battle count as destroyed.

- Strategic Reserves units can arrive in the Reinforcements step of your Movement phase, from the second battle round onwards.
- Those not on the battlefield at the end of the battle count as destroyed.

SETTING UP STRATEGIC RESERVES UNITS

Where on the battlefield a Strategic Reserves unit can be set up when it arrives depends on the battle round, as follows:

- During the second battle round, Strategic Reserves units that arrive must be set up wholly within 6" of any battlefield edge, but no model in those units can be set up within the enemy deployment zone.
- Starting from the third battle round, Strategic Reserves units that arrive must be set up wholly within 6" of any battlefield edge.

In any case, Strategic Reserves units cannot be set up within 9" horizontally of any enemy models. All other rules that apply when setting up Reserves units also apply when setting up Strategic Reserves units.

- During the second battle round, set up wholly within 6" of any battlefield edge (not in enemy deployment zone).
- From the third battle round onwards, set up wholly within 6" of any battlefield edge.
- Cannot be set up within 9" of any enemy models.